FOR FOUNDERS WHOSE CUSTOMER SAYS, LET'S TRY IT

Never start a pilot without these four terms.

Agree them in writing.



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I coach founders.

1

First, set a decision date.

A pilot is a test. A test ends on a day.



Put the end date in the email

A date in your head is not an agreement.

Name who makes the final call

The champion rarely signs. Ask who does.

No date, no pilot

Framework from founder coaching. No external figures.

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2

Second, pick one success metric.

Two metrics let everyone claim a win or a miss.

Use a number the customer already tracks

Hours saved, tickets closed, or revenue touched.



Write down the baseline on day one

You cannot show a lift from a number nobody recorded.

Unmeasured means unproven

Framework from founder coaching. No external figures.


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THE RISK

An open-ended pilot is unpaid work with a nicer name.

Everyone stays polite. Nobody decides.



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3

Third, attach a price.

A fee, or the price they pay if it works.

Charge something, even a small fee

It gives the test a budget line and an owner.



Or write the post-pilot price down

Put it in the same document, before the test starts.

A price makes it a real test

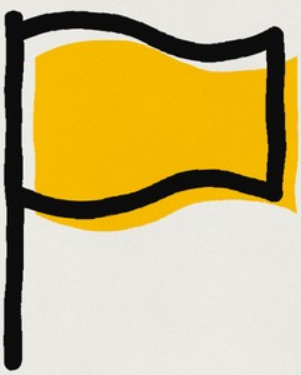
Framework from founder coaching. No external figures.


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4

Finally, say what happens next.

End the pilot with a default, not a debrief.



Write what a pass triggers

A contract, a rollout, or a named next step.

Write what a miss triggers

An agreed stop beats a slow fade.

Decide the ending first

Framework from founder coaching. No external figures.

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Send this one page before day one

- **Decision date and decision maker**
  Who decides, and by when.
- **One success metric with a baseline**
  The number, and where it starts.
- **A fee or a written price**
  Money now or money named.
- **A pass outcome and a miss outcome**
  What each result sets in motion.

↳ **Both sides reply, agreed**



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Send the one-pager before the pilot starts.

Four terms. One page. Agreed in writing.

Repost for a founder with a pilot on the table



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